prepare for the course. Once Veena had left for work, I would sit down to study, sitting Isha down on the study table itself. She would scribble on a sheet of paper, and I would scribble down my notes. I had got a set of pink-coloured notepads made, in which to make notes, and these became quite popular among the officers earmarked for subsequent courses. I daresay that my notes 'attended' the JC course at least half a dozen times, being passed on from one officer to another, often without my knowledge, and I had the devil of a time retrieving these notes when it came down to studying for the DSSC exam. I did well on the course, securing an A(I) grade, which once again boosted my confidence in myself. I was fortunate to have had excellent instructors in (then) Col Mohinder Puri and Col Suryavanshi, who extracted the best out of us.

By the time I returned from JC, my tenure was coming to an end, so rather than taking over the duties of Adjutant again, the Commandant made me a kind of officer on special duty (OSD), to follow through on his key result areas (KRA) and push through projects that were either lagging behind or mired in red tape. One such project was the Regimental Museum, the siting of which was done in such a manner as to save the maximum number of trees, and truckloads of mud had to be got in to create the mound on which the museum stands today. Another project was to resuscitate the billiards table, which, for some reason, had remained packed for a decade, ever since the Centre had moved to Fatehgarh. This 'discovery' led to a flurry of searches in all the storerooms throughout the Centre, which yielded many riches. In all units are such *khazanas*, treasures that somehow get overlooked or forgotten and more often than not, decay in storage.

When the IPKF had initially gone into Sri Lanka, they were welcomed by the predominantly Tamil population of the

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